
UNIT-V NUMERICAL METHODS

Topic Learning Objectives:

With Completion of this unit, students will be able to:

- Apply finite difference concepts to construct forward and backward difference tables from given data.
- Use Newton–Gregory forward and backward interpolation formulae and Lagrange interpolation formula to estimate unknown values from discrete data points.
- Perform numerical differentiation using interpolation formulae to determine rates of change such as velocity and acceleration.
- Apply numerical integration techniques, including Simpson’s 1/3 rule, Simpson’s 3/8 rule, and Weddle’s rule, to approximate definite integrals.
- Solve application-oriented problems in science and engineering using interpolation, differentiation, and integration methods.

In the digital world, we often need solutions to mathematical problems that have no exact answer or are too complex for direct calculation. Numerical methods provide practical techniques to approximate these solutions with high accuracy-making them a cornerstone of computational problem-solving. Begin with finite differences and the concepts of forward and backward differences, which are the foundation for interpolation and extrapolation. These allow us to estimate unknown values from known data points, a process used in computer graphics, weather prediction, and sensor data analysis.

Through Newton–Gregory and Lagrange interpolation, you’ll learn how to construct functions that fit given data, enabling smooth curves and predictive models. Numerical differentiation will let you estimate rates of change such as velocity and acceleration when only discrete data is available, which is essential in engineering simulations, robotics, and motion tracking. Finally, numerical integration techniques-like Simpson’s rules and Weddle’s rule give powerful tools to approximate areas, volumes, and other quantities in scientific computing, physics, and data analysis.

This unit equips you with algorithmic approaches to handle real-world problems where exact mathematics meets computational practicality.

Introduction:

Numerical analysis plays a great role in engineering and in the quantitative parts of pure and applied science. Interpolation, the computing of values for a tabulated function at points not in the table, is historically a most important task. Many famous mathematicians have their names associated with procedures for interpolation: Gauss, Newton, Bessel, Stirling. The need to interpolate began with the early studies of astronomy when the motion of heavenly bodies was to be determined from periodic observations. Interpolation methods demonstrate some important theory about polynomials and the accuracy of numerical methods. Interpolating

with polynomials serves as an excellent introduction to some techniques for drawing smooth curves. These methods are the basis of many other procedures. Among these procedures, we will focus on numerical differentiation and integration in this unit.

Interpolation and Extrapolation:

Interpolation is the technique of estimating the value of a function for any intermediate value of the independent variable while the process of computing the value of the function outside the given range is called extrapolation.

Finite Differences:

The finite difference deals with the changes in the value of the function (dependent variable) due to the changes in the values of independent variable. The values of the independent variable x are called Arguments and the corresponding values of dependent variables y are called Entries.

Forward difference:

If $y_0, y_1, y_2, \dots, y_n$ denote the set of values of the function $y = f(x)$. Then $\Delta y_0 = y_1 - y_0$, $\Delta y_1 = y_2 - y_1, \dots, \Delta y_{n-1} = y_n - y_{n-1}$ are called the First Forward Differences of the function $y = f(x)$ where Δ is called the forward difference operator. The differences are called first forward differences denoted by $\Delta y_0, \Delta y_1, \dots, \Delta y_{n-1}$ second forward differences and are denoted by $\Delta^2 y_0, \Delta^2 y_1, \dots, \Delta^2 y_{n-2}$. i.e. $\Delta^2 y_0 = \Delta y_1 - \Delta y_0, \Delta^2 y_1 = \Delta y_2 - \Delta y_1, \dots, \Delta^2 y_{n-2} = \Delta y_{n-1} - \Delta y_{n-2}$.

Similarly, we can define third, fourth forward differences etc.

In general, the n^{th} forward differences is defined by the equation, $\Delta^n y_i = \Delta^{n-1} y_{i+1} - \Delta^{n-1} y_i$

Forward Difference Table:

x	$y = f(x)$	Δy	$\Delta^2 y$	$\Delta^3 y$	$\Delta^4 y$	$\Delta^5 y$
x_0	y_0					
$x_1 = x_0 + h$	y_1	Δy_0				
$x_2 = x_0 + 2h$	y_2	Δy_1	$\Delta^2 y_0$			
$x_3 = x_0 + 3h$	y_3	Δy_2	$\Delta^2 y_1$	$\Delta^3 y_0$	$\Delta^4 y_0$	
$x_4 = x_0 + 4h$	y_4	Δy_3	$\Delta^2 y_2$	$\Delta^3 y_1$	$\Delta^4 y_1$	$\Delta^5 y_0$
$x_5 = x_0 + 5h$	y_5	Δy_4	$\Delta^2 y_3$	$\Delta^3 y_2$		

Here y_0 is called the First Entry and $\Delta y_0, \Delta^2 y_0, \Delta^3 y_0, \Delta^5 y_0$ are called the leading forward differences.

Backward Difference:

Consider the function $y = f(x)$. If $y_0, y_1, y_2, \dots, y_n$ denote the set of values of y . Then $\nabla y_1 = y_1 - y_0, \nabla y_2 = y_2 - y_1, \dots, \nabla y_n = y_n - y_{n-1}$ are called the First Backward Differences and ∇ is called the backward difference operator. The second backward difference of the function is given by, $\nabla^2 y_2 = \nabla y_2 - \nabla y_1, \nabla^2 y_3 = \nabla y_3 - \nabla y_2, \dots, \nabla^n y_n = \nabla y_n - \nabla y_{n-1}$. Similarly, we can define higher order differences. In general, the n^{th} backward difference is given by $\nabla^n y_i = \nabla^{n-1} y_i - \nabla^{n-1} y_{i-1}$.

Backward Difference Table:

x	$y = f(x)$	∇y	$\nabla^2 y$	$\nabla^3 y$	$\nabla^4 y$	$\nabla^5 y$
x_0	y_0					
$x_1 = x_0 + h$	y_1	∇y_1				
$x_2 = x_0 + 2h$	y_2	∇y_2	$\nabla^2 y_2$	$\nabla^2 y_3$	$\nabla^4 y_4$	
$x_3 = x_0 + 3h$	y_3	∇y_3	$\nabla^2 y_3$	$\nabla^3 y_4$	$\nabla^4 y_5$	$\nabla^5 y_5$
$x_4 = x_0 + 4h$	y_4	∇y_4	$\nabla^2 y_4$	$\nabla^3 y_5$		
$x_5 = x_0 + 5h$	y_5	∇y_5	$\nabla^2 y_5$			

NOTE: Only the notations are changed not the differences.

- Relation between forward and backward operators: $\Delta^n y_r = \nabla^n y_{n+r}$
- $\Delta f(x) = f(x + h) - f(x)$
- $\nabla f(x) = f(x) - f(x - h)$

Problems:

1. Evaluate $\Delta \tan^{-1} x$

Solution: $\Delta \tan^{-1} x = \tan^{-1}(x + h) - \tan^{-1} x = \tan^{-1} \left\{ \frac{x+h-x}{1+(x+h)x} \right\} = \tan^{-1} \left\{ \frac{h}{1+hx+x^2} \right\}$

2. Evaluate $\Delta^2 \cos 2x$

Solution: $\Delta^2 \cos 2x = \Delta^2 \{ \cos 2(x + h) - \cos 2x \}$
 $= \Delta \cos 2(x + h) - \Delta \cos 2x$
 $= [\cos 2(x + 2h) - \cos 2(x + h)] - [\cos 2(x + h) - \cos 2x]$
 $= -2 \sin(2x + 3h) \sin h + 2 \sin(2x + h) \sin h$
 $= -2 \sin h [\sin(2x + 3h) - \sin(2x + h)]$
 $= -2 \sin h [2 \cos(2x + 2h) \sin h]$
 $= -4 \sin^2 h \cos(2x + 2h)$

Differences of a Polynomial:

The n^{th} differences of a polynomial of the n^{th} degree are constant and all higher order differences are zero. Let $f(x) = a_0 x^n + a_1 x^{n-1} + \dots + a_n$, then

$\Delta^n f(x) = a_0 n(n-1)(n-2) \dots 1. h^n = a_0 n! h^n$ (1)

and then for higher orders $\Delta^{n+1} f(x) = \Delta^{n+2} f(x) = \dots = 0$(2)

Problems:

1. Evaluate $\Delta^{10} [(1 - ax)(1 - bx^2)(1 - cx^3)(1 - dx^4)]$ with $h = 1, h = 2$.

Solution: Given,

$\Delta^{10} [(1 - ax)(1 - bx^2)(1 - cx^3)(1 - dx^4)] = \Delta^{10} [abcd x^{10} + ()x^9 + ()x^8 + \dots + 1]$
 $= abcd \Delta^{10} (x^{10}) \quad [\Delta^{10} (x^k) = 0 \text{ for } k < 10]$
 $= abcd (10!)$ (for $h = 1$)

Similarly, for $h = 2$,
 $= abcd (10!) (2)^{10}$

2. Construct the forward difference table, given that

x	5	10	15	20	25	30
y	9962	9848	9659	9397	9063	8660

and find the values of $\Delta^2 y_{10}, \Delta^3 y_5, \Delta^4 y_5$.

Solution:

x	y	Δy	$\Delta^2 y$	$\Delta^3 y$	$\Delta^4 y$
5	9962	-114			
10	9848	-189	-755	2	
15	9659	-2622	-73	1	-1
20	9397	-334	-72	3	2
25	9063	-4033	-69		
30	8660				

Now $\Delta^2 y_{10} = -73$ which is second element for the column $\Delta^2 y$, $\Delta^3 y_5 = 2$ which is the first element of the column $\Delta^3 y$. Similarly $\Delta^4 y_5 = -1$.

3. Construct the finite difference table for the function $f(x) = x^3 + x + 1$ where x takes the values 0,1,2,3,4,5,6. Identify the leading forward and backward differences. Hence find $\Delta^2 y_1$, $\nabla^3 y_5$.

Solution:

x	y	First difference	Second difference	Third difference	Fourth difference
0	1	2			
1	3	8	6		
2	11	20	12	6	0
3	31	38	18	6	0
4	69	62	24	6	0
5	131	92	30	6	
6	223				

The leading forward differences are 2, 6, 6 and leading backward differences are 92, 30, 6. $\Delta^2 y_1 = 12$, $\nabla^3 y_5 = 6$.

Note: Third differences are constants and higher order differences are zero as $f(x)$ is a polynomial of third degree.

Interpolation

Interpolation is a numerical technique used to estimate unknown values between known data points. In computer science, it plays an important role in graphics (smooth curve rendering and animation), data science (estimating missing data), machine learning (function approximation), and scientific computing. Methods like Newton-Gregory and Lagrange interpolation construct a polynomial that passes through given data points, allowing prediction of intermediate values when the exact functional form is unknown.

Newton's Forward Interpolation Formula:

Let the function $y = f(x)$ takes the values $y_0, y_1, \dots, y_n$ at the points $x_0, x_1, \dots, x_n$ where $x_i = x_0 + ih$. Then Newton's Forward interpolation polynomial is given by,

$$y_p = f(x) = y_0 + p\Delta y_0 + \frac{p(p-1)}{2!} \Delta^2 y_0 + \frac{p(p-1)(p-2)}{3!} \Delta^3 y_0 + \dots + \frac{p(p-1)\dots(p-n-1)}{n!} \Delta^n y_0,$$

where $x = x_0 + ph$

Newton's Backward Interpolation Formula:

Let the function $y = f(x)$ takes the values $y_0, y_1, \dots, y_n$ at the points $x_0, x_1, \dots, x_n$, where $x_i = x_0 + ih$. The Newton's Backward Interpolation polynomial is given by,

$$y_p = f(x) = y_n + p\nabla y_n + \frac{p(p+1)}{2!} \nabla^2 y_n + \frac{p(p+1)(p+2)}{3!} \nabla^3 y_n + \dots + \frac{p(p+1)\dots(p+n-1)}{n!} \nabla^n y_n,$$

where $x = x_n + ph$

Remark:

Newton's Forward Interpolation Formula is used to interpolate the values of y near the beginning of the set of tabulated values or for extrapolating values of y to the left of the beginning. Newton's Backward Interpolation Formula is used to interpolate the values of y near the end of the set of tabulated values or for extrapolating values of y to the right of the last tabulated value y .

Examples:

1. Find a cubic polynomial which takes the following data

x	0	1	2	3
$f(x)$	1	2	1	10

Solution: The forward difference table is given by,

x	$y = f(x)$	Δy	$\Delta^2 y$	$\Delta^3 y$
0	1			
1	2	1		
2	1	-1	-2	
3	10	9	10	12

Here, $x_0 = 0$, $h = 1$, $p = \frac{x-x_0}{h} = \frac{x-0}{1} = x$, $\Delta y_0 = 1$, $\Delta^2 y_0 = -2$, $\Delta^3 y_0 = 12$. By Newton-Gregory forward interpolation formula we have

$$f(x) = y_0 + p\Delta y_0 + \frac{p(p-1)}{2!}\Delta^2 y_0 + \frac{p(p-1)(p-2)}{3!}\Delta^3 y_0 + \dots$$

$$f(x) = 1 + x(1) + \frac{x(x-1)}{2!}(-2) + \frac{x(x-1)(x-2)}{3!}(12)$$

$$f(x) = 2x^3 - 7x^2 + 6x + 1 \text{ is the required polynomial.}$$

2. The table gives the distance in nautical miles of the visible horizon for the given heights in feet above the earth's surface.

$x = \text{height:}$	150	200	250	300	350	400
$y = \text{distance:}$	13.03	15.04	16.81	18.42	19.90	21.27

Find the values of y when $x = 160ft$ and $x = 410ft$.

Solution: The difference table is

x	y	First difference	Second difference	Third difference	Fourth difference	Fifth difference

150	13.03					
200	15.04	2.01				
250	16.81	1.77	-0.24	0.08	-0.05	
300	18.42	1.61	-0.13	0.03	-0.01	0.04
350	19.90	1.48	-0.11	0.02		
400	21.27	1.37				

- (i) $x_0 = 160$, $y_0 = 13.03$, $\Delta y_0 = 2.01$, $\Delta^2 y_0 = -0.24$, $\Delta^3 y_0 = 0.08$, $\Delta^4 y_0 = -0.05$, $h = 50$

$$p = \frac{x-x_0}{h} = \frac{10}{50} = 0.2$$

Using Newton's forward interpolation formula, we get

$$f(160) = y_0 + p\Delta y_0 + \frac{p(p-1)}{2!}\Delta^2 y_0 + \frac{p(p-1)(p-2)}{3!}\Delta^3 y_0 + \dots$$

$$f(160) = 13.03 + 0.402 + 0.0192 + 0.00384 + 0.00168 + 0.001$$

$$f(160) = 13.46 \text{ nautical miles.}$$

- (ii) $x = 410$, $x_n = 400$, $y_n = 21.27$, $\nabla y_n = 1.37$, $\nabla^2 y_n = -0.11$, $\nabla^3 y_n = 0.02$, $h = 50$

$$p = \frac{x-x_n}{h} = \frac{10}{50} = 0.2$$

Using Newton's backward interpolation formula we get,

$$f(410) = y_n + p\nabla y_n + \frac{p(p+1)}{2!}\nabla^2 y_n + \frac{p(p+1)(p+2)}{3!}\nabla^3 y_n + \dots$$

$$f(410) = 21.27 + 0.2(1.37) + \frac{0.2(1.2)}{2}(-0.11) + \dots$$

$$f(410) = 21.27 + 0.274 + 0.0132 + 0.0018 + 0 + 0.0024$$

$$f(410) = 21.53 \text{ nautical miles.}$$

3. From the following table, estimate the number of students who obtained marks between 40 and 45.

Marks (x):	30-40	40-50	50-60	60-70	70-80
No. of students(y):	31	42	51	35	31

Solution: we prepare cumulative frequency table as follows:

Marks less than(x):	40	50	60	70	80
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No. of students(y):	31	73	124	159	190
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Now the difference table is:

x	y	Δy	$\Delta^2 y$	$\Delta^3 y$	$\Delta^4 y$
40	31	42			
50	73	51	9		
60	124	35	-16	-25	
70	159	31	-4	12	37
80	190				

To find $y(45)$ i.e. number of students with marks less than 45.

Taking $x_0 = 40$, $x = 45$, $h = 10$, $p = \frac{x-x_0}{h} = \frac{5}{10} = 0.5$

Using Newton's Forward Interpolation formula we get,

$$\begin{aligned}
 y(45) &= y_{40} + p\Delta y_{40} + \frac{p(p-1)}{2}\Delta^2 y_{40} + \frac{p(p-1)(p-2)}{6}\Delta^3 y_{40} + \dots \\
 &= 31 + 0.5(42) + \frac{0.5(-0.5)}{2}(9) + \frac{0.5(0.5)(-1.5)}{6}(-25) + \frac{0.5(-0.5)(-1.5)(-2.5)}{24}(37) \\
 &= 47.87
 \end{aligned}$$

The number of students with marks less than 45 is $47.87 \cong 48$.

But the number of students with marks less than 40 is 31.

Hence the number of students getting marks between 40 and 45 is $48 - 31 = 17$.

4. Construct an empirical formula for the function y specified in the table. Hence find $y(-1)$ and $y(0.5)$.

x	0	1	2	3	4	5
y	5.2	8	10.4	12.4	14	15.2

x	y	Δy	$\Delta^2 y$	$\Delta^3 y$	$\Delta^4 y$
0	5.2	2.8			
1	8	2.4	-0.4		
2	10.4	2	-0.4	0	
3	12.4	1.6	-0.4	0	0
4	14	1.2	-0.4	0	0
5	15.2				

Here $x_0 = 0$, $h = 1$, $p = \frac{x-x_0}{h} = x$, $\Delta y_0 = 2.8$, $\Delta^2 y_0 = -0.4$, $\Delta^3 y_0 = 0$. By Newton-

Gregory forward interpolation formula we have

$$y(x) = y_0 + p\Delta y_0 + \frac{p(p-1)}{2!}\Delta^2 y_0 + \frac{p(p-1)(p-2)}{3!}\Delta^3 y_0 + \dots$$

$$y = 5.2 + x(2.8) + x(x-1)/2! (-0.4)$$

$$y = -0.2x^2 + 3x + 5.2$$

$$y(-1) = 2$$

$$y(-0.5) = 6.65$$

5. Using appropriate Newton's formula, compute the pressure of the steam at temperature 142° and 179° from the following steam table.

Temperature	140	150	160	170	180
Pressure	3.685	4.854	6.302	8.076	10.225

x	y	Δy	$\Delta^2 y$	$\Delta^3 y$	$\Delta^4 y$
140	3.685	1.169			
150	4.854	1.448	0.279		
160	6.302	1.774	0.326	0.047	
170	8.076	2.149	0.375	0.049	0.002
180	10.225				

i) $x_0 = 140$, $y_0 = 3.685$, $\Delta y_0 = 1.169$, $\Delta^2 y_0 = 0.279$, $\Delta^3 y_0 = 0.047$, $\Delta^4 y_0 = -0.02$, $h = 10$, $p = \frac{x-x_0}{h} = \frac{142-140}{10} = 0.2$

Using Newton's forward interpolation formula, we get

$$y(142) = y_0 + p\Delta y_0 + \frac{p(p-1)}{2!}\Delta^2 y_0 + \frac{p(p-1)(p-2)}{3!}\Delta^3 y_0 + \dots$$

$$y(142) = 3.685 + 0.2338 + 0.0223 + 0.0023$$

$$y(142) = 3.8988.$$

ii) $x = 179$, $x_n = 180$, $y_n = 10.225$, $\nabla y_n = 2.149$, $\nabla^2 y_n = 0.375$, $\nabla^3 y_n = 0.049$, $\nabla^4 y_n = 0.002$

$$h = 10$$

$$p = \frac{x-x_n}{h} = \frac{179-180}{10} = -0.1$$

Using Newton's backward interpolation formula we get,

$$y(179) = y_n + p\nabla y_n + \frac{p(p+1)}{2!}\nabla^2 y_n + \frac{p(p+1)(p+2)}{3!}\nabla^3 y_n + \dots$$

$$y(179) = 10.225 - 0.2149 - 0.0169 - 0.0014$$

$$y(179) = 9.9918.$$

6. The following data gives the melting point of an alloy of lead and zinc, where t is the temperature in deg-C and p is the percentage of lead in the alloy.

p	40	50	60	70	80	90
t	184	204	226	250	276	304

Using Newton's interpolation formula, find the melting point of the alloy containing 84 percent of lead.

p	t	Δt	$\Delta^2 t$	$\Delta^3 t$
40	184			
50	204	20		
60	226	22	2	0
70	250	24	2	0
80	276	26	2	0
90	304	28		

Solution:

$$h = 10 \quad p = \frac{84 - 90}{10} = -0.6$$

$$t_{84} = 304 - (0.6 * 28) + (-0.6)(-0.6 + 1) * \frac{2}{2!} = 304 - 16.8 - 0.24 = 287$$

Exercise:

1. Fit a cubic polynomial to the following data using suitable interpolation formula.

x	0	1	2	3
$f(x)$	-2	2	12	34

2. Using Newton-Gregory Interpolation formula, estimate $f(0.12)$ from the following data.

x	0.10	0.15	0.20	0.25	0.30
$f(x)$	0.1003	0.1511	0.2027	0.2553	0.3093

3. Apply Newton's backward difference interpolation formula to find $f(7.5)$ from the following table:

x	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
$f(x)$	1	8	27	64	125	216	343	512

4. Using Newton -Gregory Interpolation formulae, find $f(17)$ from the following data.

x	0	4	8	12	16	20	24
$f(x)$	0	0.0699	0.1405	0.2126	0.2867	0.3640	0.4452

5. The population of a town is given by the table:

Year	1951	1961	1971	1981	1991
Population in thousand	19.96	39.65	58.81	77.21	94.61

Using Newton's forward and backward interpolation formula, calculate the increase in the population from the year 1955 to 1985. Ans: $y(1955) = 28000$, $y(1985) = 84000$.

6. The deflection ' d ' measured at various distances x from one end of a cantilever is given below. Find ' d ' when $x = 0.95$ using appropriate interpolation formula.

x	0.0	0.2	0.4	0.6	0.8	1.0
d	0.0	0.035	0.117	0.2165	0.2995	0.334

Ans: $d(0.95) = 0.3314$

7. Using Newton's interpolation formulae, find $y(9)$ and $y(17)$ for the following data:

x	8	10	12	14	16	18
y	40	58	88	134	206	320

Interpolation with unequal intervals

Lagrange's formula for unequal intervals:

Let $y = f(x)$ be a function whose values are $y_0, y_1, y_2, \dots, y_n$ corresponding to $x_0, x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n$ not necessarily equally spaced.

$$f(x) = \frac{(x-x_1)(x-x_2)\dots(x-x_n)}{(x_0-x_1)(x_0-x_2)\dots(x_0-x_n)}y_0 + \frac{(x-x_0)(x-x_2)\dots(x-x_n)}{(x_1-x_0)(x_1-x_2)\dots(x_1-x_n)}y_1 + \dots + \frac{(x-x_0)(x-x_1)\dots(x-x_{n-1})}{(x_n-x_0)(x_n-x_1)\dots(x_n-x_{n-1})}y_n$$

This formula is known as Lagrange's Interpolation formula.

Inverse interpolation:

The process of estimating the value of x for a given value of y is called Inverse interpolation. So far given a table of values of x and y , using one of the interpolation formulae we find the value of y corresponding to some value of x which is not in the table. On the other hand, the process of estimating the value of x for some value of y which is not in the table is called inverse interpolation.

This method is used when the values of x are not necessarily equally spaced. Lagrange's interpolation formula can be simply viewed as a relation between two variables and any one of the variable can be taken as an independent variable. Therefore, inverse interpolation formula can be obtained by interchanging the variables x and y in Lagrange's formula, we get.

$$x = \frac{(y-y_1)(y-y_2)\dots(y-y_n)}{(y_0-y_1)(y_0-y_2)\dots(y_0-y_n)} x_0 + \frac{(y-y_0)(y-y_2)\dots(y-y_n)}{(y_1-y_0)(y_1-y_2)\dots(y_1-y_n)} x_1 + \dots + \frac{(y-y_0)(y-y_1)\dots(y-y_{n-1})}{(y_n-y_0)(y_n-y_1)\dots(y_n-y_{n-1})} x_n$$

Problems:

1. By using the Lagrange's interpolation formula to fit a polynomial to the data given

x	0	1	3	4
y	-12	0	6	12

Hence, find y when $x = 2$.

Solution:

$$x_0 = 0 \quad x_1 = 1 \quad x_2 = 3 \quad x_3 = 4$$

$$y_0 = -12 \quad y_1 = 0 \quad y_2 = 6 \quad y_3 = 12$$

By Lagrange's formula

$$y = \frac{(x-1)(x-3)(x-4)}{(0-1)(0-3)(0-4)} (-12) + \frac{(x-0)(x-3)(x-4)}{(1-0)(1-3)(1-4)} (0) + \frac{(x-0)(x-1)(x-4)}{(3-0)(3-1)(3-4)} (6) + \frac{(x-0)(x-1)(x-3)}{(4-0)(4-1)(4-3)} (12)$$

$$y = (x-1)(x-3)(x-4) - (x)(x-1)(x-4) + x(x-1)(x-3)$$

$$= (x-1)[x^2 - 7x + 12 - x^2 + 4x + x^2 - 3x]$$

$$= (x-1)(x^2 - 6x + 12)$$

$$y = x^3 - 7x^2 + 18x - 12$$

For $x = 2$, we get $y = 4$.

2. Apply Lagrange's formula to find $f(5)$ and $f(6)$ given that $f(1) = 2$, $f(2) = 4$, $f(3) = 8$, $f(7) = 128$ and explain why the results differ from those obtained by $f(x) = 2^x$.

Solution: $x_0 = 1$, $x_1 = 2$, $x_2 = 3$, $x_3 = 7$

By Lagrange's formula, we have

$$f(x) = \frac{(x-2)(x-3)(x-7)}{(1-2)(1-3)(1-7)} f(x_0) + \frac{(x-1)(x-3)(x-7)}{(2-1)(2-3)(2-7)} f(x_1) + \frac{(x-1)(x-2)(x-7)}{(3-1)(3-2)(3-7)} f(x_2) + \frac{(x-1)(x-2)(x-3)}{(7-1)(7-2)(7-3)} f(x_3)$$

$$f(x) = \frac{(x-2)(x-3)(x-7)}{-12} (2) + \frac{(x-1)(x-3)(x-7)}{5} (4) + \frac{(x-1)(x-2)(x-7)}{-8} (8) + \frac{(x-1)(x-2)(x-3)}{120} (128)$$

$$f(5) = \frac{(3)(2)(-2)}{-12} (2) + \frac{(4)(2)(-2)}{5} (4) + \frac{(4)(3)(-2)}{-8} (8) + \frac{(4)(3)(2)}{120} (128)$$

$$f(5) = 2 - 12.8 + 24 + 25.6 = 38.8$$

$$f(6) = \frac{(4)(3)(-1)}{-12} (2) + \frac{(5)(3)(-1)}{5} (4) + \frac{(5)(4)(-1)}{-8} (8) + \frac{(5)(4)(3)}{120} (128)$$

$$f(6) = 2 - 12 + 20 + 64 = 74$$

But actual values of $f(5)$ and $f(6)$ are $f(5) = 2^5 = 32$ and $f(6) = 2^6 = 64$. The difference in values of $f(5)$ and $f(6)$ are due to the assumption of $f(x)$ as a polynomial, when it is an exponential function of the form 2^x .

3. Find x corresponding to $y = 7$ using Lagrange's inverse interpolation formula.

x	1	3	4
y	4	12	19

Solution:

$$x_0 = 1 \quad x_1 = 3 \quad x_2 = 4, \quad y_0 = 4 \quad y_1 = 12 \quad y_2 = 19$$

$$x = \frac{(y-y_1)(y-y_2)}{(y_0-y_1)(y_0-y_2)} x_0 + \frac{(y-y_0)(y-y_2)}{(y_1-y_0)(y_1-y_2)} x_1 + \frac{(y-y_0)(y-y_1)}{(y_2-y_0)(y_2-y_1)} x_2$$

$$= \frac{(y-12)(y-19)}{(4-12)(4-19)} (1) + \frac{(y-4)(y-19)}{(12-4)(12-19)} (3) + \frac{(y-4)(y-12)}{(19-4)(19-12)} (4)$$

$$\text{at } y = 7, \quad x = \frac{60}{120} + \frac{108}{56} - \frac{60}{105} = 1.85714$$

4. Find $f(3)$ by using Lagrange interpolation formula

x	0	1	2	4
y	1	12	19	27

$$y = \frac{(3-1)(3-2)(3-4)}{(-1)(-2)(-4)} 1 + \frac{(3-0)(3-2)(3-4)}{(1)(-1)(-3)} 12 + \frac{(3-0)(3-1)(3-4)}{(1)(2)(-2)} 19 + \frac{(3-0)(3-1)(3-2)}{(4)(3)(2)} 27$$

$$y = \frac{1}{4} - 12 + \frac{57}{2} + \frac{27}{4} = \frac{47}{2} = 23.5$$

5. Find the root of the equation $f(x) = 0$, given that $f(30) = -30$, $f(34) = -13$, $f(38) = 3$ and $f(42) = 18$.

Solution: Here $x_0 = 30, x_1 = 34, x_2 = 38, x_3 = 42, y_0 = -30, y_1 = -13, y_2 = 3, y_3 = 18$.

It is required to find x for $y = f(x) = 0$. By Lagrange's formula for inverse interpolation,

$$x = \frac{(y-y_1)(y-y_2)(y-y_3)}{(y_0-y_1)(y_0-y_2)(y_0-y_3)} x_0 + \frac{(y-y_0)(y-y_2)(y-y_3)}{(y_1-y_0)(y_1-y_2)(y_1-y_3)} x_1 + \frac{(y-y_0)(y-y_1)(y-y_3)}{(y_2-y_0)(y_2-y_1)(y_2-y_3)} x_2 +$$

$$\frac{(y-y_0)(y-y_1)(y-y_2)}{(y_3-y_0)(y_3-y_1)(y_3-y_2)} x_3$$

$$x = \frac{(0+13)(0-3)(0-18)}{(-30+13)(-30-3)(-30-18)} 30 + \frac{(0+30)(0-3)(0-18)}{(-13+30)(-13-3)(-13-18)} 34 + \frac{(0+30)(0+13)(0-18)}{(3+30)(3+13)(3-18)} 38 +$$

$$\frac{(0+30)(0+13)(0-3)}{(18+30)(18+13)(18-3)} 42$$

$$x = -0.782 + 6.5323 + 33.6818 - 2.2016$$

Hence, the root of $f(x) = 0$ is 37.2305

Exercise:

1. Using suitable interpolation formula, fit a polynomial for the data

x	0	1	3	4
y	-12	0	6	12

Hence estimate y at $x = 2$.

2. Find the age corresponding to the annuity value 13.6 from the given table:

Age (x)	30	35	40	45	50
Annuity value (y)	15.9	14.9	14.1	13.3	12.5

[Ans: 43]

3. Find the value of y at $x = 2$ from the following table:

x	1	3	4	6
y	-3	9	30	132

[Ans: 0]

4. Using Lagrange interpolation formula, find $f(x)$ which takes the values 1, 4, 40, 85, as $x = 0, 1, 3, 4$.

[Ans: $x^3 + x^2 + x + 1$]

Numerical Differentiation

Numerical differentiation approximates the derivative of a function using discrete data points when the analytical derivative is difficult or impossible to obtain. Using finite difference formulas (forward, backward, or central differences), it estimates rates of change such as velocity, acceleration, or gradients. In computer science, it is widely used in optimization algorithms, machine learning (gradient estimation), image processing (edge detection), and simulation systems.

Let the function $y = f(x)$ is given by a table of values (x, y) then the process of computing the derivatives $\frac{dy}{dx}, \frac{d^2y}{dx^2}$ etc. for some particular value of x is called Numerical Differentiation.

Derivatives using Newton's forward interpolation formula:

By Newton's Interpolation Formula, we have

$$y = y_0 + P\Delta y_0 + \frac{P(P-1)}{2!} \Delta^2 y_0 + \frac{P(P-1)(P-2)}{3!} \Delta^3 y_0 + \dots \quad (1)$$

$$\text{where, } x = x_0 + Ph \text{ (or) } P = \frac{x - x_0}{h} \quad \dots\dots\dots (2)$$

Differentiating (1) with respect to P, we get

$$\frac{dy}{dP} = \Delta y_0 + \frac{(2P-1)}{2!} \Delta^2 y_0 + \frac{3P^2+6P+2}{3!} \Delta^3 y_0 + \frac{(4P^3-18P^2+22P-6)}{4!} \Delta^4 y_0 + \dots\dots\dots (3)$$

Differentiating (2) with respect to x, we get

$$\frac{dP}{dx} = \frac{1}{h} \dots\dots\dots (4) \quad \text{But, } \frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{dy}{dP} \cdot \frac{dP}{dx}. \text{ Using (3) and (4) the above equation becomes,}$$

$$\left(\frac{dy}{dx} \right)_{x=x_0+Ph} = \frac{1}{h} \left[\Delta y_0 + \frac{(2P-1)}{2!} \Delta^2 y_0 + \frac{(3P^2-6P+2)}{3!} \Delta^3 y_0 + \frac{(4P^3-18P^2+22P-6)}{4!} \Delta^4 y_0 + \dots \right] \dots\dots (5)$$

At $x = x_0$, $P = 0$, the above equation becomes,

$$\left(\frac{dy}{dx} \right)_{x=x_0} = \frac{1}{h} \left[\Delta y_0 - \frac{1}{2} \Delta^2 y_0 + \frac{1}{3} \Delta^3 y_0 - \frac{1}{4} \Delta^4 y_0 + \dots \right] \dots\dots (6)$$

Formula (5) is used to compute y' at any point $x = x_0 + Ph$, whereas formula (6) is used to compute y' at any of the value of x when y is specified. Similarly,

$$\left(\frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} \right)_{x=x_0+Ph} = \frac{1}{h^2} \left[\Delta y_0 + (P-1) \Delta^3 y_0 + \frac{(6P^2-18P+11)}{12} \Delta^4 y_0 + \dots \right] \dots\dots (7)$$

$$\text{and } \left(\frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} \right)_{x=x_0} = \frac{1}{h^2} \left[\Delta^2 y_0 - \Delta^3 y_0 + \frac{11}{12} \Delta^4 y_0 - \frac{5}{6} \Delta^5 y_0 + \dots \right] \dots\dots (8)$$

The formula (7) is used to compute y'' at any point $x = x_0 + Ph$ whereas formula (8) is used to compute y'' at any value of x where y is specified.

Derivatives using Newton's backward interpolation formula:

By Newton's Backward Interpolation Formula, we have

$$y = y_n + \frac{P}{1!} \nabla y_n + \frac{P(P+1)}{2!} \nabla^2 y_n + \frac{P(P+1)(P+2)}{3!} \nabla^3 y_n + \dots\dots\dots (1)$$

$$\text{where, } x = x_n + Ph \text{ (or) } P = \frac{x - x_n}{h} \quad \dots\dots\dots (2)$$

Differentiating (1) with respect to P, we get

$$\frac{dy}{dP} = \nabla y_n + \frac{(2P+1)}{2!} \nabla^2 y_n + \frac{(3P^2+6P+2)}{3!} \nabla^3 y_n + \dots\dots\dots (3)$$

Differentiating (2) with respect to x, we get

$$\frac{dP}{dx} = \frac{1}{h} \dots\dots (4) \quad \text{But, } \frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{dy}{dP} \cdot \frac{dP}{dx}$$

Using (3) and (4) the above equation becomes,

$$\left(\frac{dy}{dx} \right)_{x=x_n+Ph} = \frac{1}{h} \left[\nabla y_n + \frac{(2P+1)}{2!} \nabla^2 y_n + \frac{(3P^2+6P+2)}{3!} \nabla^3 y_n + \dots \right] \dots\dots (5)$$

At $x = x_n$, $P = 0$, the above equation becomes,

$$\left(\frac{dy}{dx}\right)_{x=x_n} = \frac{1}{h} \left[\nabla y_n + \frac{1}{2} \nabla^2 y_n + \frac{1}{3} \nabla^3 y_n + \frac{1}{4} \nabla^4 y_n + \dots \right] \quad \dots (6)$$

Formula (5) is used to compute y' at any point $x = x_n + Ph$ whereas formula (6) is used to

compute y' at any of the values of x when y is specified. Similarly,

$$\left(\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}\right)_{x=x_n+Ph} = \frac{1}{h^2} \left[\nabla^2 y_n + (P+1) \nabla^3 y_n + \frac{(6P^2+18P+11)}{12} \nabla^4 y_n + \dots \right] \quad \dots (7)$$

$$\left(\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}\right)_{x=x_n} = \frac{1}{h^2} \left[\nabla^2 y_n + \nabla^3 y_n + \frac{11}{12} \nabla^4 y_n + \frac{5}{6} \nabla^5 y_n + \frac{137}{180} \nabla^6 y_n + \dots \right] \quad \dots (8)$$

The formula (7) is used to compute y'' at any point $x = x_n + Ph$ whereas formula (8) is used to compute y'' at any of the values of x when y is specified.

Problems:

1. Given

x	1.0	1.2	1.4	1.6	1.8	2.0
y	2.72	3.32	4.06	4.96	6.05	7.39

Find y' and y'' at $x = 1.2$.

Solution: Here, the step-length is $h = 0.2$. We first form the following difference table.

x	y	first differences	Second differences	Third differences	Fourth differences
1.0	2.72				
1.2	3.32	0.60			
1.4	4.06	0.74	0.14		
1.6	4.96	0.90	0.16	0.02	
1.8	6.05	1.09	0.19	0.03	0.01
2.0	7.39	1.34	0.25	0.06	0.03

We have to compute y' and y'' at $x = 1.2$, which is a specified value of x , for this purpose, we take $x_0 = 1.2$. Then we find from the table that,

$$\Delta y_0 = 0.74, \quad \Delta^2 y_0 = 0.16, \quad \Delta^3 y_0 = 0.03, \quad \Delta^4 y_0 = 0.03$$

Using the formula we have,

$$\left(\frac{dx}{dy}\right)_{x=x_0} = \frac{1}{h} \left[\Delta y_0 - \frac{1}{2} \Delta^2 y_0 + \frac{1}{3} \Delta^3 y_0 - \frac{1}{4} \Delta^4 y_0 + \dots \right]$$

$$\text{Then, } \left(\frac{dy}{dx}\right)_{(1.2)} = \frac{1}{(0.2)} \left[(0.74) - \frac{1}{2} (0.16) + \frac{1}{3} (0.03) - \frac{1}{4} (0.03) \right] = 3.3125$$

Using the formula we have,

$$\left(\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}\right)_{x=x_0} = \frac{1}{h^2} \left[\Delta^2 y_0 - \Delta^3 y_0 + \frac{11}{12} \Delta^4 y_0 - \frac{5}{6} \Delta^5 y_0 + \dots \right]$$

$$\text{And } \left(\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}\right)_{1.2} = \frac{1}{(0.2)^2} \left[(0.16) - (0.03) + \frac{11}{12} (0.03) \right] = 3.39375$$

2. Using appropriate interpolation formulas, find the values of y' and y'' when $x = 4$ using the following table.

x	1	2	3	4
y	4	12	20	36

Solution: Here $x = 4$ is a specified value of x which is at the end of the given table.

For this purpose, we take $x_n = 4$.

The difference table is given by,

x	y	First differences	Second differences	Third differences
1	4			
2	12	8		
3	20	8	0	
4	36	16	8	8

Here $x_n = 4$, $\nabla y_n = 16$, $\nabla^2 y_n = 8$, $\nabla^3 y_n = 8$ and $h = 1$

$$\text{Then, } y'(4) = \frac{1}{h} \left[(\nabla y_n) + \frac{1}{2} (\nabla^2 y_n) + \frac{1}{3} (\nabla^3 y_n) \right] = \frac{1}{1} \left[16 + \frac{1}{2} (8) + \frac{1}{3} (8) \right]$$

$$y'(4) = 16 + 4 + \frac{8}{3} = 22.667$$

$$y''(4) = \frac{1}{h^2} \left[\frac{1}{2} (\nabla^2 y_n) + (\nabla^3 y_n) \right] = \frac{1}{1^2} [8 + 8] = 16$$

3. A rod is rotating in a plane, the following table gives the angle θ (in radians) through which the rod is turned for various values of time t (in seconds): Find the angular velocity and angular acceleration at $t = 0.4$ sec.

Solution: Given

t	0	0.2	0.4	0.6	0.8	1.0	1.2
θ	0	0.12	0.49	1.12	2.02	3.20	4.67

To compute velocity $\frac{d\theta}{dt}$ and acceleration $\frac{d^2\theta}{dt^2}$ at $t = 0.4$ sec

The finite difference table is given by

x	θ	First differences	second differences	Third differences	Fourth differences
0	0	0.12	0.25		
0.2	0.12	0.37	0.26	0.01	
0.4	0.49	0.63	0.27	0.01	0.00
0.6	1.12	0.90	0.28	0.01	0.00
0.8	2.02	1.18	0.29		0.00

1.0	3.20	1.47			
1.2	4.67				

To compute $\frac{d\theta}{dt}$ and $\frac{d^2\theta}{dt^2}$ at $t = 0.4$ sec, which is specified value of t . We take $t_0 = 0.4$
 $\Delta\theta_0 = 0.63, \Delta^2\theta_0 = 0.21, \Delta^3\theta_0 = 0.01, \Delta^4\theta_0 = 0.00$

Using the formula,

$$\left(\frac{d\theta}{dt}\right)_{x=x_0} = \frac{1}{h} \left[\Delta y_0 - \frac{1}{2} \Delta^2 y_0 + \frac{1}{3} \Delta^3 y_0 - \frac{1}{4} \Delta^4 y_0 + \dots \right]$$

$$\left(\frac{d\theta}{dt}\right)_{(0.4)} = \frac{1}{0.2} \left[(0.63) - \frac{1}{2} (0.27) + \frac{1}{3} (0.01) \right] = 2.49$$

And using the formula,

$$\left(\frac{d^2\theta}{dt^2}\right)_{x=x_0} = \frac{1}{h^2} \left[\Delta^2 y_0 - \Delta^3 y_0 + \frac{11}{12} \Delta^4 y_0 - \frac{5}{6} \Delta^5 y_0 + \dots \right]$$

$$\left(\frac{d^2\theta}{dt^2}\right)_{(0.4)} = \frac{1}{(0.2)^2} [(0.27) - 0.01] = 6.5$$

4. The following table gives the temperature θ (in degree Celsius) of a cooling body at different instants of time t (in seconds)

T	1	3	5	7	9
θ	85.3	74.5	67.0	60.5	54.3

Find approximately the rate of cooling at $t = 8$ seconds.

Solution: Rate of cooling = $\frac{d\theta}{dt}$

The backward difference table is given by,

T	θ	First differences	second differences	Third differences	Fourth differences
1	85.3				
3	74.5	-10.8			
5	67.0	-7.5	3.3		
7	60.5	-6.5	1.0	-2.3	
9	54.3	-6.2	0.3	-0.7	1.6

Here, to compute $\frac{d\theta}{dt}$ at $t = 8$ sec., which is not the specified value of t

We have, $t_n = t_4 = 9, \theta_n = \theta_4 = 54.3$

$\nabla\theta_4 = -6.2, \nabla^2\theta_4 = 0.3, \nabla^3\theta_4 = -0.7, \nabla^4\theta_4 = 1.6$

$$p = \frac{t-t_4}{h} = -0.5$$

Using the formula, we have

$$\left(\frac{dy}{dx}\right)_{x=x_n} = \frac{1}{h} \left[\nabla y_n + \frac{2p+1}{2!} \nabla^2 y_n + \frac{3p^2+6p+2}{3!} \nabla^3 y_n + \frac{4p^3+18p^2+22p+6}{4!} \nabla^4 y_n + \dots \right]$$

$$\begin{aligned} \left(\frac{d\theta}{dt}\right)_{(t=8)} &= \frac{1}{2} \left[-6.2 + \frac{2(-.05) + 1}{2} (0.3) + \frac{3(-0.5)^2 + 6(.5) + 2}{6} (-0.7) \right. \\ &\quad \left. + \frac{4(-0.5)^3 + 18(-0.5)^2 + 22(-.05) + 6}{24} (1.6) \right] \\ &= \frac{1}{2} [-6.2 + 0 + 0.029166 - 0.066666] = -3.11875 \end{aligned}$$

Thus, the body cools at the rate of 3.11875 degree/second.

5. A slider in a machine moves along a fixed straight rod. Its distance x cm along the rod is given below for various values of the time ' t ' seconds. Find the velocity of the slider and its acceleration when $t = 0.3$ second.

t	0	0.1	0.2	0.3	0.4	0.5	0.6
x	30.13	31.62	32.87	33.64	33.95	33.81	33.24

Solution: To compute velocity and acceleration at $t = 0.3$ sec, we use values of ' t ' from 0.2 to 0.6. The finite difference table is given by

t	x	First differences	second differences	Third differences	Fourth differences
0.2	32.87				
0.3	33.64	0.77			
0.4	33.95	0.31	-0.46		
0.5	33.81	-0.41	-0.45	0.01	
0.6	33.24	-0.57	-0.43	0.02	0.01

To compute $\frac{dx}{dt}$ and $\frac{d^2x}{dt^2}$ at $t = 0.3$ sec, which is specified value of t . We take $t_0 = 0.3$
 $\Delta x_0 = 0.31$, $\Delta^2 x_0 = -0.45$, $\Delta^3 x_0 = 0.02$

Using the formula,

$$\left(\frac{dx}{dt}\right)_{t=t_0} = \frac{1}{h} \left[\Delta x_0 - \frac{1}{2} \Delta^2 x_0 + \frac{1}{3} \Delta^3 x_0 - \frac{1}{4} \Delta^4 x_0 + \dots \right]$$

$$\left(\frac{dx}{dt}\right)_{(0.3)} = \frac{1}{0.1} \left[(0.31) - \frac{1}{2} (-0.45) + \frac{1}{3} (0.02) \right] = 5.417 \text{ cm/sec}$$

And using the formula,

$$\left(\frac{d^2x}{dt^2}\right)_{t=t_0} = \frac{1}{h^2} \left[\Delta^2 x_0 - \Delta^3 x_0 + \frac{11}{12} \Delta^4 x_0 - \frac{5}{6} \Delta^5 x_0 + \dots \right]$$

$$\left(\frac{d^2x}{dt^2}\right)_{(0.3)} = \frac{1}{(0.01)} [(-0.45) - 0.02] = -47 \text{ cm/sec}^2$$

Exercise:

1. Given that,

x	1.0	1.1	1.2	1.3	1.4	1.5	1.6
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

y	7.989	8.403	8.781	9.129	9.451	9.750	10.031
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Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$, $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}$ at $x = 1.1$ and $x = 1.6$.

2. A slider in a machine moves along a fixed straight rod. Its distance x cm along the rod is given below for various values of the time 't' seconds. Find the velocity of the slider and its acceleration when $t = 0.1$ second.

t	0	1.0	1.2		1.4	1.6	1.8	2.0
x	30.13	31.62	32.87		33.64	33.95	33.81	33.24

3. Find $\frac{dx}{dy}$ and $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}$ at $x = 1.1$ of the function tabulated below:

x	1.0	1.2	1.4	1.6	1.8	2.0
f(x)	0	0.128	-.544	1.296	2.432	4.00

4. Compute $y'(0)$ and $y''(0)$ from the following table:

x	0	1	2	3	4	5
y	4	8	15	7	6	2

5. Find $f'(1.5)$ using the differentiation formula based on Newton's interpolation for the following data:

x	1	2	3	4	5	6
f(x)	4	9	16	25	36	49

Numerical Integration

Numerical integration estimates the value of definite integrals when an exact analytical solution is unavailable. Techniques such as the Trapezoidal Rule, Simpson's 1/3 rule, 3/8 rule, and Weddle's rule approximate the area under a curve using weighted sums of function values. In computer science, numerical integration is applied in probability computations, machine learning (area under curve, expectation values), physics simulations, signal processing, and computational finance.

Numerical integration is a process of evaluating a definite integral from a set of tabulated values of the integrand $f(x)$. If the integrand is a function of a single-valued, then the numerical integration is known as Quadrature.

Newton – Cote's Quadrature formula:

Let $I = \int_a^b f(x) dx$, where $f(x)$ takes the value $y_0, y_1, y_2, \dots, y_n$ for $x = x_0, x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n$.

Divide the interval (a, b) into n sub-intervals of width h , so that $x_0 = a$, $x_1 = x_0 + h$, $x_2 = x_0 + 2h, \dots, x_n = x_0 + nh = b$. Let $x = x_0 + rh$ then $dx = h dr$. Also, when

$x = x_0, r = 0$ and when $x = x_0 + nh, r = n, I = \int_0^n f(x_0 + rh)h dr$. Now by Newton's forward interpolation formula, we have

$$I = h \int_0^n \left[y_0 + r\Delta y_0 + \frac{r(r-1)}{2!} \Delta^2 y_0 + \frac{r(r-1)(r-2)}{3!} \Delta^3 y_0 + \dots \right] dr$$

Integrating term by term, we get

$$I = h \left[y_0 r + \frac{r^2}{2} \Delta y_0 + \frac{1}{2!} \left(\frac{r^3}{3} - \frac{r^2}{2} \right) \Delta^2 y_0 + \frac{1}{3!} \left(\frac{r^4}{4} - r^3 + r^2 \right) \Delta^3 y_0 + \dots \right]_0^n$$

$$I = nh \left[y_0 + \frac{n}{2} (\Delta y_0) + \frac{1}{2!} \left(\frac{n^2}{3} - \frac{n}{2} \right) (\Delta^2 y_0) + \frac{1}{3!} \left(\frac{n^2}{4} - n^2 + n \right) (\Delta^3 y_0) + \dots \right]$$

This formula is known as Newton-Cote's Quadrature formula or a general Quadrature formula.

Taking $n = 1, 2, 3, 6$ in Quadrature formula, we have

- $n = 1 \longrightarrow$ Trapezoidal rule (not in the syllabus)
- $n = 2 \longrightarrow$ Simpson's 1/3rd rule
- $n = 3 \longrightarrow$ Simpson's 3/8th rule
- $n = 6 \longrightarrow$ Weddle's rule

1. Simpson's 1/3rd rule:

By taking $n = 2$ in the general Quadrature formula and neglecting terms containing $\Delta^3 y_0, \Delta^4 y_0, \dots$, then we get

$$I = \frac{h}{3} [(y_0 + y_n) + 4(y_1 + y_3 + \dots + y_{n-1}) + 2(y_2 + y_4 + \dots + y_{n-2})]$$

This formula is known as Simpson's one-third rule

Note: This formula is applicable only when n is a multiple of 2.

2. Simpson's 3/8th rule:

By taking $n = 3$ in the general Quadrature formula and neglecting terms containing $\Delta^4 y_0, \Delta^5 y_0, \dots$ we get

$$I = \frac{3h}{8} [(y_0 + y_n) + 3(y_1 + y_2 + y_4 + y_5 + \dots + y_{n-1}) + 2(y_3 + y_6 + \dots + y_{n-3})]$$

This formula is known as Simpson's three-eight rule

Note: This formula is applicable only when n is a multiple of 3

3. Weddle's rule:

By taking n as multiple of 6 in the general Quadrature formula

$$\int_{x_0}^{x_0 + nh} f(x) dx = \frac{3h}{10} [(y_0 + y_n) + 5(y_1 + y_5 + \dots + y_{n-5} + y_{n-1}) + (y_2 + y_4 + \dots +$$

$$y_{n-4} + y_{n-2}) + 2(y_6 + y_{12} + \dots + y_{n-6}) + 6(y_3 + y_9 + \dots + y_{n-3})]$$

This formula is known as Weddle's rule. In particular, taking $n = 6$ in Weddle's rule

$$I = \frac{3h}{10}(y_0 + 5y_1 + y_2 + 6y_3 + y_4 + 5y_5 + y_6)$$

Note: This formula is applicable only when n is a multiple of 6.

Problems:

1. A solid of revolution is formed by rotating about the x -axis, the area between the x -axis, the line $x = 0$ and $x = 1$ and a curve through the points with the following coordinates.

x	0.00	0.25	0.50	0.75	1.00
y	1.0000	0.9896	0.9589	0.9089	0.8415

If the volume of the solid is given by the integral $\int_0^1 \pi y^2 dx$, determine the approximate volume of the solid.

Solution:

By Simpson's $\frac{1}{3}$ rule, we have (here $h = 0.25$)

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^1 \pi y^2 dx &= \pi \frac{h}{3} [(y_0^2 + y_4^2) + 4(y_1^2 + y_3^2) + 2(y_2^2)] \\ &= \frac{0.25}{3} \pi \{1 + (0.8415)^2 + 4[(0.9896)^2 + (0.9089)^2] + 2(0.9589)^2\} \\ &= \frac{(0.25)(3.1416)}{3} [1.7081 + 4(0.9793 + 0.8261) + 1.8389] \\ &= (0.2618) [1.7081 + 7.2216 + 1.8389] \\ &= (0.2618) (10.7686) = 2.8192. \end{aligned}$$

2. Calculate $\int_4^{5.2} \log x dx$ using (a) Simpson's $1/3^{\text{rd}}$ rule (b) Simpson's $3/8^{\text{th}}$ rule (c) Weddle's rule.

Solution: $h = \frac{5.2-4}{6} = \frac{1.2}{6} = 0.2$

x	4	4.2	4.4	4.6	4.8	5.0	5.2
y	1.386	1.43508	1.48160	1.52605	1.5686	1.6094	1.6486

- (a) By Simpson's $1/3^{\text{rd}}$ rule

$$\begin{aligned} I &= \frac{h}{3} [(y_0 + y_6) + 4(y_1 + y_3 + y_5) + 2(y_2 + y_4)] \\ &= \frac{0.2}{3} [(1.38629 + 1.6486) + 4(1.43508 + 1.52605 + 1.60943) + 2(1.48160 + 1.56861)] \end{aligned}$$

$$= \frac{0.2}{3} [3.034953 + 18.28224 + 6.10042]$$

$$= \frac{0.2}{3} (27.41761)$$

$$= 1.82784$$

(b) Simpson's $3/8^{\text{th}}$ Rule

$$I = \frac{3h}{8} [(y_0 + y_6) + 3(y_1 + y_2 + y_4 + y_5) + 2y_3]$$

$$I = \frac{3(0.2)}{8} [(1.38629 + 1.64865) + 3(1.43508 + 1.48160 + 1.56861 + 1.60943) + 2(1.52605)]$$

$$= \frac{0.6}{8} [3.034953 + 18.28416 + 3.052]$$

$$= \frac{0.6}{8} [24.371213]$$

$$= 1.82784$$

(c) Weddle's Rule

$$I = \frac{3h}{10} [(y_0 + y_6) + 5y_1 + y_2 + 6y_3 + y_4 + 5y_5]$$

$$I = \frac{3(0.2)}{10} [(1.38629 + 5(1.43508) + 1.48160 + 6(1.52605) + 1.56861 + 5(1.60943) + 1.64865]$$

$$= \frac{0.6}{10} [1.38629 + 7.1754 + 1.48160 + 9.1563 + 1.5686 + 8.04715 + 1.64865]$$

$$= \frac{0.6}{10} [30.464]$$

$$= 1.82784$$

3. Evaluate $\int_0^6 \frac{dx}{1+x^2}$ using (a) Simpsons $1/3^{\text{rd}}$ rule (b) Simpsons $3/8^{\text{th}}$ rule (c) Weddle's rule

Solution:

Dividing the interval $(0, 6)$ into six equal parts of width $h = \frac{6-0}{6} = 1$

x	0	1	2	3	4	5	6
$f(x)$	1	0.5	0.2	0.1	0.0588	0.0385	0.027

(a) Simpson's $1/3^{\text{rd}}$ rule

$$\int_0^6 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx = \frac{h}{3} [(y_0 + y_6) + 4(y_1 + y_3 + y_5) + 2(y_2 + y_4)]$$

$$= \frac{1}{3} [(1 + 0.027) + 4(0.5 + 0.1 + 0.0385) + 2(0.2 + 0.0588)]$$

$$= \frac{1}{3} [1.027 + 2.554 + 0.5176]$$

$$= 1.3662$$

(b) Simpson's $3/8^{\text{th}}$ Rule

$$\int_0^6 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx = \frac{3h}{8} [(y_0 + y_6) + 3(y_1 + y_2 + y_4 + y_5) + 2y_3]$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= \frac{3(1)}{8} [(1 + 0.027) + 3(0.5 + 0.2 + 0.0588 + 0.0385) + 2(0.1)] \\
 &= \frac{3}{8} [1.027 + 2.3919 + 0.2] \\
 &= 1.3571
 \end{aligned}$$

(c) Weddle's Rule

$$\begin{aligned}
 \int_0^6 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx &= \frac{3h}{10} [(y_0 + 5y_1 + y_2 + 6y_3 + y_4 + 5y_5 + y_6)] \\
 &= \frac{3(1)}{10} [(1 + 5(0.5) + 0.2 + 6(0.1) + 0.0588 + 5(0.385) + 6.027] \\
 &= 1.3735
 \end{aligned}$$

4. Evaluate $\int_{0.2}^{1.4} (\sin x - \log_e x + e^x) dx$ by dividing the interval into six parts using Simpson's one-third, three-eighth rule and Weddle's rule. Compare the result with the exact solution.

Solution:

x	0.2	0.4	0.6	0.8	1	1.2	1.4
$y = f(x)$	3.0295	2.7975	2.8976	3.1660	3.5598	4.0698	4.7042

(a) Simpson's 1/3rd rule

$$\begin{aligned}
 \int_{0.2}^{1.4} (\sin x - \log_e x + e^x) dx &= \frac{h}{3} [(y_0 + y_6) + 4(y_1 + y_3 + y_5) + 2(y_2 + y_4)] \\
 &= \frac{0.2}{3} [(3.0295 + 4.7042) + 4(2.7975 + 3.1660 + 4.0698) + 2(2.8976 + 3.5598)] \\
 &= 4.0528
 \end{aligned}$$

(b) Simpson's 3/8th Rule

$$\begin{aligned}
 \int_{0.2}^{1.4} (\sin x - \log_e x + e^x) dx &= \frac{3h}{8} [(y_0 + y_6) + 3(y_1 + y_2 + y_4 + y_5) + 2y_3] \\
 &= \frac{3(0.2)}{8} [(3.0295 + 4.7042) + 3(2.7975 + 2.8976 + 3.5598 + 4.0698) + 2(3.1660)] \\
 &= 4.0530
 \end{aligned}$$

(c) Weddle's Rule

$$\begin{aligned}
 \int_{0.2}^{1.4} (\sin x - \log_e x + e^x) dx &= \frac{3h}{10} [(y_0 + 5y_1 + y_2 + 6y_3 + y_4 + 5y_5 + y_6)] \\
 &= \frac{3(0.2)}{10} [(3.0295 + 5(2.7975) + 2.8976 + 6(3.1660) + 3.5598 + 5(4.0698) + 4.7042] \\
 &= 4.0509
 \end{aligned}$$

5. The speed, v meter per second, of a car, t second after it starts, is shown in the following table. Find the distance travelled by the car in 2 minutes, using Simpson's 1/3rd rule.

T (time)	0	12	24	36	48	60	72	84	96	108	120
V (Speed)	0.5	3.6	10.08	18.90	21.6	18.54	10.26	4.5	4.5	5.4	9

Solution: Let s (meters) distance be travelled in t (seconds).

$$\frac{ds}{dt} = v \Rightarrow \int ds = \int v dt \Rightarrow s = \int v dt$$

The distance travelled in 2 minutes, i.e. 120 seconds is $s = \int_0^{120} v dt$

By using Simpson's 1/3 rule, $s = \int_0^{120} v dt$

$$\begin{aligned}
 s &= \frac{h}{3} [(y_0 + y_6) + 4(y_1 + y_3 + y_5) + 2(y_2 + y_4)] \\
 &= \frac{12}{3} [(0 + 9) + 4(3.6 + 18.9 + 18.54 + 4.5 + 5.4) + 2(10.08 + 21.6 + 10.26 + 4.5)] \\
 &= 4(9 + 203.76 + 92.88) \\
 &= 1222.56 \text{ meters}
 \end{aligned}$$

Exercise:

1. By using Simpson's 1/3rd rule evaluate $\int_0^5 \frac{dx}{4x+5}$ by dividing range into 10 equal parts. Hence find an approximate value of $\log_e 5$.

2. By Simpson's 1/3 rule evaluate $\int_0^2 f(x)dx$, given

x	0.0	0.5	1.0	1.5	2.0
$f(x)$	0.399	0.352	0.242	0.129	0.054

3. The following tables gives six values of an independent variable x and the corresponding values of y .

x	0.0	1	2	3	4	5	6
$f(x)$	0.46	0.161	0.176	0.190	0.204	0.217	0.230

Evaluate using Simpson's 3/8th rule.

4. Evaluate $\int_0^1 \frac{x dx}{1+x^2}$ using Simpson's 3/8th rule dividing the interval into three equal parts. Hence find an approximate value of $\log \sqrt{2}$.

5. Evaluate $\int_3^6 f(x)dx$ using Weddle's rule from the following data;

x	3.0	3.5	4.0	4.5	5.0	5.5	6.0
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$f(x)$	0.4771	0.5440	0.6020	0.6532	0.6996	0.7404	0.7782
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Video Links:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NxtxB4k6R3o>

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iviiGB5vxLA>

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7IAUJlUKu1A>

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